

stronger bond with Ben and his sister Virginia than their father was. Susan continually pointed out the fact that it was she who attended the PTA meetings, their sports practices, their doctor's appointments, and all the other daily routines that took place when Charles was not around.

His mom was trying to make herself more important than Charles in their children's lives and it was working. Charles felt so inadequate that whenever he saw his children he tried to make up for his time away from them by showering them with gifts. He would take them out to expensive restaurants, take them away on weekend vacations, and buy them anything they wanted at the shopping mall.

Deducing Charles's psychological connection to money is obvious by looking at his spending pattern. He spent money to cover up the guilt he felt over not spending enough time with Ben and Virginia. Like Charles, most people tend to have a certain mood, which may trigger spending money. In order to figure out your mood, the next time you are shopping for the wants (not needs) in life, what mood tends to predominate? Do you shop when you are bored, depressed, or celebrating? Keeping a journal of your money moods while you are spending money will help you figure out your tendencies:

Date	Activity	Mood	Comments
Example: July 22, 2007	Shopping at the mall	Depressed	Boyfriend dumped me
August 22, 2007	Purchasing art	Lonely	Haven't had a date in a month

